GRINDSTONE WRESTLING

Extra games

INDEX + SEVEN GAME CARDS / FOUR DOUBLE-SIDED SHEETS

Two team favorites and five coaching adaptations. Choose a familiar activity and the version that fits your athletes' readiness. Timings, resets, scoring options, and age choices are marked as suggestions.

FIND THE GAME

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PRINT AND FILE

Print this PDF on Letter paper at 100%, double-sided, flipping on the long edge. Its eight pages make four sheets. Append it after the original binder's page 208; the combined set is 216 pages / 108 sheets.

This addendum has its own index. The original binder, index, PDFs, and library ZIP remain unchanged and do not include these seven additions.

USE THE DEMONSTRATIONS

Each card links a related video and names its source. Source linkage and title/publisher metadata were checked; footage was not watched. Teach the written version and its contact limits before starting the game.

Ankle Tag

G31 / TEAM FAVORITE / SUGGESTED 4 MINUTES

Paired, touch-only ankle tag.

SET UP

Equipment: Clear mat space. Optional: soft, flat, washable wrestling ankle bands as visible targets only; no hard parts or loose ends.

Match partners by size, experience, and control. Give each pair a clear area with space between pairs. Demonstrate a gentle open-hand ankle touch and the stop signal.

HOW TO PLAY

Stay with your assigned partner. A gentle touch to an ankle scores one point; no grip or takedown. The reset and scoring below are suggested coaching choices.

1. Begin in a comfortable wrestling stance with eyes up and hands ready. Move your feet to stay balanced.

2. Reach with an open hand and gently touch your partner's ankle. Never hold the ankle, shoe, sock, or band.

3. After a touch, say "one," separate, and return to stance before restarting. Stop and reset if the pair leaves its area.

4. Use the suggested short rounds below, then pause to reset or switch the attacker. Keep every athlete involved.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup: 15-20 seconds, cooperative, one attacker at a time; switch roles. Ages 7-10: 20-30 seconds, both may score when they show control. Ages 11-14: 30-40 seconds, add a footwork challenge while keeping the same gentle touch rule. Choose a shorter round whenever control fades.

COACH WATCH

Touch only. No diving, gripping, pushing, tripping, sweeping, or takedowns. Never grab, pull, or remove an ankle band. A band is a visual target, not a flag to collect. Stop immediately if partners collide, fall, or become rough.

Say this: Touch, do not grab. | Move your feet; stay balanced. | One touch, reset.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Toe Tag
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_sVdY3tjqjg

Official curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched. Use hand-to-ankle touches, never foot-stepping.

Team favorite shared by a coach. Added timing, resets, scoring/rotation, and age choices are suggestions.

Bulldog

G32 / TEAM FAVORITE / SUGGESTED 5 MINUTES

Also called Sharks and Minnows. Team rule: hip to mat = new shark.

SET UP

Equipment: Clear mat space and two visible end lines. Keep the playing area away from walls, chairs, and other groups.

Everyone moves on hands and knees. Choose one starting shark in the middle; minnows begin behind one end line. Use a short crossing lane and enough space to separate pairs. Coach first demonstrates a controlled body action the athletes have already learned that guides a partner's hip gently to the mat. If they cannot show it cooperatively, use the torso-touch adaptation.

HOW TO PLAY

On the coach's signal, minnows crawl toward the opposite end line. The team's core rule is hip to mat = new shark. The release, entry timing, and rotation below are suggested coaching choices.

1. Allow only one shark to engage each minnow. Other sharks must choose an unengaged minnow; never add a second athlete to an active pair.

2. Using only the previously taught controlled body action, the shark guides the minnow's hip gently to the mat. Keep contact controlled; no lifting or forcing.

3. As soon as the hip touches, the shark releases. Both athletes separate. The new shark joins on the next crossing, after the current crossing ends.

4. Reset everyone on hands and knees before the next signal. Use short rounds, rotate the starting shark, and restart before crowding or fatigue spoils control.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: Pup / ages 4-6 and any new athlete: gentle torso touch only, with no tipping; touched minnows join as sharks on the next crossing. Ages 7-10 and 11-14: rehearse the selected controlled hip finish with a cooperative partner first; use it only when every athlete can perform and receive it calmly. Readiness, not age, decides the version. Suggested format: 30-45-second rounds with a reset and a new starting shark.

COACH WATCH

No piling on, lifts, headlocks, neck pulls, twisting trapped legs, or dragging by joints or clothing. No standing, running, tackling, or force progression. Release immediately at the hip touch or stop signal. Pause the whole game if an athlete is trapped, uncomfortable, or loses control; return to touch-only play.

Say this: Hands and knees. | One shark, one minnow. | Hip touches: release and reset.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Sharks & Minnows
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ByuqM7Itd1o

Official curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched.

Team favorite shared by a coach. Added timing, resets, scoring/rotation, and age choices are suggestions.

Tail Tag

G33 / COACHING ADAPTATION / SUGGESTED 4 MINUTES

A paired flag game adapted from Fox Tail: protect your tail and collect your partner's.

SET UP

Equipment: One soft cloth flag per athlete and clear mat space. Use loose flags with no hard parts; never tie or fasten them to the body.

Match partners by size, experience, and control. Each athlete loosely tucks a cloth into the back of the waistband with an easy-to-grab end showing. Give every pair its own clear area. Show a gentle flag pull and the stop signal.

HOW TO PLAY

Partners circle to protect their own flag while trying to pull the other flag free. Only the flag is a target. The scoring and reset below are suggested coaching choices.

1. Begin facing your assigned partner with knees soft and eyes up. Keep the flag loose enough to come free easily.

2. Use footwork to reach the flag. Grasp only the exposed cloth; never grab the waistband, clothing, or body.

3. One flag pulled free earns one point. Stop, separate, return the flag, and tuck it loosely before restarting.

4. Suggested rounds: 15-20 seconds followed by a reset. Switch partners or roles only when the coach directs.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup and new athletes: walking only, one attacker and one defender; switch roles each round. Ages 7-10: both may attack after showing control. Ages 11-14: challenge athletes to change direction while staying balanced; keep the same light-contact rules. Choose the walking version whenever space or control is limited.

COACH WATCH

Only grab the loose flag. No tying flags, gripping clothing or the body, pushing, blocking with contact, tackling, diving, or pulling someone off balance. Stop to fix a stuck flag; never tug harder. Reset if athletes leave their area.

Say this: Flag only. | Move your feet; protect your tail. | Pull, pause, reset.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Fox Tail
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TsyfHK_OD4k

Official curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched.

Coaching adaptation of a named source game. Added timing, resets, scoring, contact limits, and age choices are suggestions.

Towel Tug

G34 / COACHING ADAPTATION / SUGGESTED 4 MINUTES

A controlled grip-and-balance game adapted from Bone Fight.

SET UP

Equipment: One short, soft towel per pair and clear mat space. No knots, handles, straps, or hard attachments.

Match partners by size, experience, and control. Partners face each other in a balanced stance and each holds one end of the towel with one hand. Keep the towel below shoulder height and leave room for footwork. Demonstrate gentle pressure and a safe release.

HOW TO PLAY

Keep your balance and move your feet while applying gentle pressure through the towel. If a partner releases the towel, stop immediately. The one-point/reset format below is a suggested coaching choice.

1. Take a comfortable stance with soft knees and eyes up. Hold the towel in an open, releasable grip; never wrap it around the hand or wrist.

2. On the signal, use gentle steady pressure and small steps. The purpose is balance and grip control, not pulling someone down.

3. A voluntary grip release ends the exchange and gives the partner one point. Both relax, return to the starting position, and reset.

4. Release immediately if you lose balance. Suggested older-athlete rounds: up to 20 seconds, then reset or change hands.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup and new athletes: cooperative balance only, with very light shared tension and no contest or points. Ages 7-10: brief gentle exchanges after a controlled release rehearsal. Ages 11-14: add small direction changes or switch the gripping hand between rounds; do not increase force.

COACH WATCH

No wrist wraps, jerks, body contact, twisting arms, falling backward, or dropping body weight to win. Never chase a released towel or keep pulling after a stop. Release before losing balance; stop the game if gentle pressure cannot be maintained.

Say this: Soft knees, small steps. | Gentle pressure; no jerks. | Lose balance? Let go.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Bone Fight
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cjyHiU_bhl0

Official curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched.

Coaching adaptation of a named source game. Added timing, resets, scoring, contact limits, and age choices are suggestions.

Circle the Bear

G35 / COACHING ADAPTATION / SUGGESTED 4 MINUTES

A controlled angle-and-footwork game adapted from Spinning Bear.

SET UP

Equipment: Clear mat space; no equipment needed.

Match partners by size and readiness. One athlete is the bear, in a comfortable hands-and-feet base. The other begins in a low stance in front, with light open-hand contact on the shoulders. Demonstrate gentle contact and a controlled pivot before the game.

HOW TO PLAY

The circling athlete tries to move behind the bear while the bear pivots to keep facing the partner. This is a footwork task, not a shove or takedown. The role changes below are suggested.

1. Begin only when both athletes are balanced and comfortable. Keep the bear's head free and hands supported on the mat.

2. The partner circles with small steps, using only light shoulder contact. The bear moves hands and feet to turn and face the partner.

3. If the partner gets behind, pause and return to the front. No jump-on, ride, tackle, or extra finish follows.

4. Suggested rounds: 15 seconds, then stop and switch roles. Reset sooner if the bear's base collapses or either athlete loses control.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup and new athletes: both remain standing for a no-touch walking circle; one circles while the other turns to face. Ages 7-10: rehearse a comfortable bear base before using light contact. Ages 11-14: add direction changes while keeping slow, controlled footwork. Readiness decides the version.

COACH WATCH

No head or neck pressure, shoving the bear down, pulling arms, jumping on the back, or forcing a trapped limb. Never continue on a collapsed base. If hands, wrists, or shoulders become uncomfortable, stop and use the standing, no-touch version.

Say this: Light hands, moving feet. | Turn to face your partner. | Base drops? Stop and reset.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Spinning Bear
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n7a-Ab6RwXs

Official curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched.

Coaching adaptation of a named source game. Added timing, resets, scoring, contact limits, and age choices are suggestions.

Freeze & Rescue

G36 / COACHING ADAPTATION / SUGGESTED 5 MINUTES

A freeze-tag game with a crawling teammate rescue, adapted from UK Coaching's Stuck in the Mud.

SET UP

Equipment: Clear mat space with visible boundaries and enough room between frozen athletes.

Choose one tagger to start and demonstrate a gentle open-hand touch to the torso or shoulder. Show the frozen position: feet comfortably apart, body still. Rehearse one teammate crawling slowly between the legs without contacting them.

HOW TO PLAY

A tagged athlete freezes. A free teammate can rescue them by crawling carefully between their legs. The frozen athlete stays still until the rescuer is fully clear. The following spacing and reset choices are suggestions.

1. On the signal, free players move within the boundaries. Taggers use a light torso or shoulder touch only.

2. Tagged players stop with feet apart. If the location is crowded, pause and have the coach space everyone before restarting.

3. One teammate at a time crawls through to rescue. Taggers give the pair room and do not tag either athlete during the rescue.

4. After the rescuer is fully clear, both rejoin play. Use short rounds, rotate taggers, and reset when frozen athletes are too close together.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup and new athletes: walking only, one tagger, and a slow rescue rehearsal before play. Ages 7-10 and 11-14: add a tagger only while spacing and gentle touches remain controlled. If crawling through legs is uncomfortable or impractical, use a gentle hand-to-hand touch rescue instead. Suggested rounds: 30-45 seconds.

COACH WATCH

No lifting, tackling, pushing, leg grabbing, or diving through legs. Frozen athletes must not move their feet until the rescuer is through. Never crowd, block, or chase into an active rescue. Stop immediately if anyone is trapped or uncomfortable.

Say this: Light touch, then freeze. | Stay still for your rescuer. | One at a time; crawl slowly.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

Better Health Families: Stuck in the Mud
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OOhGdvcWMxQ

Video source: uicoach.org/recess-games/stuckinthemud
Written source: UK Coaching / Play Their Way - Wrestling games for children

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched.

Coaching adaptation of a named source game. Added timing, resets, scoring, contact limits, and age choices are suggestions.

Power Ball

G37 / COACHING ADAPTATION / SUGGESTED 5 MINUTES

A passing-and-movement game adapted from USA Wrestling's Power Ball.

SET UP

Equipment: One soft ball and a clear mat area with two marked end zones. Avoid walls, chairs, and overlapping groups.

Make two balanced teams and point out each team's attacking end zone. Demonstrate a controlled pass, a safe catch, and two steps with the ball. Agree that this version scores only by completing a pass to a teammate standing in the attacking end zone.

HOW TO PLAY

Pass and move to create space. The ball holder may take at most two steps before passing. A completed pass to a teammate standing in the attacking end zone scores one point. The restart and turnover choices below are suggestions.

1. Start with a pass from the coach or the agreed starting line. Off-ball teammates move into open space; the holder uses at most two steps and then passes.

2. Defenders may intercept a ball in flight. They may not strip, knock, or pull a ball from someone's hands.

3. A dropped ball or a ball out of bounds is a turnover. Stop, give possession to the other team at that spot, and allow a clear restart pass.

4. After a completed end-zone pass scores, reset both teams and give the other team the ball. Use short rounds and rotate roles so everyone receives passes.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup and new athletes: cooperative walking passes with no defenders; count successful passes together. Ages 7-10: introduce one gentle interception-only defender before a team game. Ages 11-14: use the full passing game only while space, catches, and stopping remain controlled. Suggested rounds: 45-60 seconds.

COACH WATCH

No stripping a held ball, tackling, charging, body blocking, or diving into players. Do not wrestle for a loose ball; stop and use the turnover rule. Use a soft ball, controlled passes, and a clear lane to the receiver. Stop if players collide or crowd the end zone.

Say this: Two steps, then pass. | Find space; show your hands. | Intercept the pass, not the player.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Power Ball
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TfpTpx0Y4es

Official curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related demonstration; follow the selected written rules. Source linkage and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched.

Coaching adaptation of a named source game. Added timing, resets, scoring, contact limits, and age choices are suggestions.